

Grace Mbeki

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Former newsroom reporter now writing for organisations rather than about them. Strongest on the page; still learning the analytics side.

EXPERIENCE

Communications Officer — Mothusi Foundation

Jan 2022 – present

- Write everything the foundation publishes: annual report narrative, 40+ press releases, donor letters and the director's speeches. The 2024 annual report was picked up by Business Day.
- Built a story bank of 30 beneficiary case studies from field interviews, which is now the source for most of our media pitching.
- Handle sensitive material constantly — beneficiary stories involve minors and health information. I built the consent process we use before anything is published, including a plain-language form and a rule that nobody under 18 is named.
- Placed features in Mail & Guardian and Sowetan by pitching reporters I knew from the newsroom.

Reporter — The Star (Johannesburg)

Jun 2018 – Dec 2021

- General news and municipal reporting. Filed roughly 300 stories, including a six-week investigation into water tender irregularities that ran across three front pages.
- Worked to daily deadlines and know exactly what a press release has to contain before a reporter will use it.

NOTES

I have not owned a formal measurement dashboard. I read coverage reports but have not built one.

EDUCATION

BJourn, Rhodes University, 2018